

Simplify to Glorify

Rituals That Relax

*Gentle, Bible-rooted ways to quiet your
body and soothe your soul*

A REFLECTION ON REST

By the time most women hear the words self care, they are already too tired to add one more thing to the list. Maybe that is where you are tonight. You have given all day to people who needed you, and the idea of caring for yourself feels like another task you will fail to finish.

So let me say it plainly before anything else. Rest is not one more thing you have to be good at. It is something God offers you, freely, in the middle of a life that asks too much.

Rest was God's idea first

We tend to treat rest as the reward we earn once everything is done. The trouble is that for most of us, everything is never done. There is always another load of laundry, and another person who will need us by morning.

Scripture tells a quieter story. When God finished making the world, He rested, and He called that rest holy. He did not rest because He was depleted. He rested to show us that stopping is woven into the good design of things, not a failure of it.

Come to Me, all who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest. Take My yoke upon you and learn from Me, for I am gentle and humble in heart, and you will find rest for your souls.

Matthew 11:28-29, NASB 2020

Notice that He does not ask you to arrive rested. He asks you to come weary, exactly as you are, and to let Him be the One who carries the weight.

Caring for your body is not unspiritual

There is a moment in the life of the prophet Elijah that I keep returning to. He had just done something brave and faithful, and then he collapsed under a tree in the wilderness and asked God to let him die. He was spent in body and in soul.

God's response is tender in a way we rarely expect. He did not correct Elijah or hand him a longer list of duties. He let him sleep. Then He sent an angel with bread and water, and He let him sleep again before a single thing was asked of him.

Sometimes the most faithful thing you can do is feed your body and close your eyes. The God who made you knows that you are dust, and He is gentle with the dust.

Small rituals that soothe the soul

Rituals do not have to be elaborate to be holy. A warm cup of tea held in both hands can be a kind of prayer. So can a slow walk where you name the things you are thankful for,

or a few minutes by a window letting your shoulders drop while you breathe.

Read a psalm out loud, slowly, the way you would read a letter from someone who loves you. You might light a candle while you pray, or rest your hand over your own heart and simply tell God that you are tired. None of this is magic. It is a small way of turning toward the One who is already near.

You are allowed to rest

You do not have to earn your rest by emptying yourself first. The rituals that relax you are not indulgences stolen from a more important life. They are how a tired woman lets her good Shepherd lead her beside still waters again.

So tonight, let one thing stay undone. Let your breathing slow. The God who rested, and who fed His exhausted prophet without a word of reproach, is not standing over you with a list. He is inviting you to be cared for, starting now.

You do not have to do more to be worthy of rest. You only have to let the One who loves you tend to the part of you that is worn thin.

More Resources

When you are worn thin and rest feels out of reach, these passages remind you that God makes room for stillness. Return to them on the days you need permission to stop.

Genesis 2:2-3

After making the world, God rested and made the seventh day holy, showing that stopping belongs to a good life.

Mark 6:31

Jesus saw that His disciples had no time even to eat, and He called them away to a quiet place to rest.

Psalms 23:1-3

The Shepherd leads the weary beside still waters and restores the soul that has been poured out.

1 Kings 19:5-7

God let His exhausted prophet sleep and gave him food before asking anything of him at all.

Matthew 11:28-29

Jesus invites the weary and burdened to come to Him and find rest for their souls.

Exodus 33:14

God promises that His own presence will go with you, and that He will give you rest.

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